



How They Work Together

When you move your mouse, the mouse senses movement and sends the necessary data to the CPU, which in turn, makes sense of the movement and translates that into X (horizontal) and Y (vertical) coordinates. This data is sent to the graphics card or video adapter, which in turn, moves the mouse pointer that's displayed on your screen to the correct co-ordinates. Since this all happens in millionths of a second, when you move your mouse, it appears to move smoothly across your screen, just as if there is a video playing. This is perhaps the most basic for of digital video that you see everyday on your computer!

It's the same basic operation for everything you see on your computer, whether it's moving a mouse, typing on the keyboard and seeing letters appear on your screen, or even watching a movie or playing a game. It's all video, and all digital.

If both monitor and graphics card support digital video inputs and outputs, respectively, you can have digital video all the way from the CPU to the monitor! Of course these are more expensive and rare, but are catching on fast.

Let's move on to the real meat of Digital Entertainment, movies and movie clips that you watch, edit or shoot with the help of your computer! But first, in the next section we'll read a little about Codecs!